

alleged creditor and debt. Not surprisingly, she never heard from the firm again, nor another word about the debt.

Jennifer is not alone. This tactic affects a lot of people, and not everyone stays calm like Jennifer. I want you to remember this last set of magic words: “*The SOL*” (or, if you prefer, **Limitations Statute**). These simple words are your bulletproof shield.

Remember what I told you in Chapter Four? You DO NOT have to pay a debt that is too old! If a creditor or a bogus law firm is hounding you, remember to keep calm, be smart, and say little, except for the two magic words, “*The SOL*.”

If he’s not aware what **SOL** stands for, go ahead and spell it out for the debt predator; be sure to remind him that you are aware of the statute of limitations. His time is up. Goodbye. Tell the caller that the debt is not collectible and hang up. Under no circumstances do you admit to the debt. (And as you’re hanging up, if you want to tell the collector that he is “SOL, buddy,” you go right ahead.)

As I’ve said before, a word to remember is “alleged.” You should call the debt that they say you owe exactly what it is: alleged. You may request details on this so-called debt, such as the account number, what it was for, when it was incurred. Go back to Chapter Four for the list of SOLs for each state. Know your rights and the law, and you can reduce or eliminate your debt completely. And all you have to do is remember the last set of magic words, “*The SOL*” (or **Limitations Statute**).

The Real Magic

There are no guarantees against identity theft, junk debt buyers, or discharged debt scams, but with common sense, awareness of the dangers, and careful attention to your financial records and credit report, you can diminish your chances of being the next victim.

Victim is not what we are. We are no longer allowing the banks and credit card companies to treat us as their victims. They have taken advantage for much too long and it is time that they get put in their place.